NOTE FOR LINUX USERS

When you install VirtualBox from your distribution's online software repositories, or by downloading the corresponding .rpm or .deb setup files from the web site, you don't get the VirtualBox guest additions with it. When you first try to install them from the "Devices" menu on the virtual machine's window, VirtualBox will report to you that the guest additions are not available and offer you to download them separately. Select "yes" for the option and wait for the download to complete. Once done, go again to the "Devices" menu and select "Install Guest Additions" option and VirtualBox will unmount the currently mounted DVD image / drive and mount the VirtualBox guest additions ISO file. Depending on your guest, you should now be able to install the guest additions. For Windows guest, click on the setup file inside the virtual DVD/CD drive. For Linux guests, you should open the terminal window in the guest and run the setup file manually with root privileges (once again, the `su` or `sudo` command).

Note that VirtualBox will unmount the current ISO file mounted into the virtual DVD/CD drive of the guest. Hence, you must make sure before installing "guest additions" that you're not using the virtual CD/DVD drive inside your guest OS to avoid problems.

it also allows you to put up a limit on the amount of load the guest can put on the processor. This feature allows you to have more control over the resource usage of your host system.

For example, if you're using VirtualBox as well as a few other resource intensive applications on your system and you started a resource-hungry process in the guest OS (let's say you're converting audio files from one format to another), this feature will make sure that the guest operating system doesn't consume all the processing power. It ensures that you can work on your host system while allowing some processor-hungry application in the guest operating system run as a background operation. The feature is extremely useful for users who don't have much processor power in their PCs and want to make sure that running virtual machine s doesn't slow down everything else. It's also useful in (indirectly) setting the priorities of the virtual machines, when more than one is running – you can set the first one to run slower and the other(s) to run faster. Used wisely, it can save a lot of trouble. Though, you should always remember that when